



The War of the Triple Alliance devastated Paraguay. This painting by Cándido López depicts the arrival of the Allied Army at Itapiru, Paraguay.

THE AMERICAN CIVIL WAR DREW TO A CLOSE. By the spring, Union troops had captured the Confederate capital of Richmond, and after several other defeats, Confederate general **Robert E. Lee** (1807–70) saw no other option but to **surrender** on April 9, signaling the end to the bloodiest conflict the US had seen. The war had left the US intact, but more than 600,000 men had been killed and half a million wounded. The new peace was soon marred: only a few days after the Union's victory, President Lincoln attended Ford's Theater in Washington, DC. There, Confederate **John Wilkes Booth** crept into the state box and shot him. Lincoln died the following morning on April 15.

The American Civil War was over, but the situation in **Mexico** remained complicated. US troops were deployed there because the

US government under Andrew Johnson (1808–75) objected to French intervention in Mexican affairs (see 1863).

Farther south, a war had erupted between **Paraguay** and its neighbors Uruguay, Brazil, and Argentina. Brazil invaded Uruguay in 1864 to assist in the overthrow of the ruling party. In response, the president of Paraguay, Francisco Solano López (1827–70), declared war on Brazil, and shortly after, on Argentina. Uruguay aligned itself with Brazil and the **War of the Triple Alliance** (also Paraguayan War) began. López was killed in battle on March 1, 1870, and a peace treaty was negotiated. The war devastated Paraguay, reducing the population of 525,000 to 221,000.

In **Jamaica**, a group of peasants who had been denied government land for planting stormed the

50,000

PARAGUAY

26,000

Alliance of
Argentina, Brazil,
and Uruguay

Forces in War of Triple Alliance
Although Paraguay had the far larger force at first, it was untrained and without a chain of command López, as leader made all decisions.

courthouse in **Morant Bay** during a meeting of the parish council, and 19 white people died in the altercation. In retaliation, governor **Edward Eyre** led a ruthless attack on the black community, declaring martial law, and killing hundreds of people

while imprisoning hundreds more. When news of this reached Britain there was a public outcry and Eyre was recalled to England.



Lincoln's death
This painting by Alonzo Chappel depicts the death of Abraham Lincoln, 16th President of the United States.



IN 1866, PERU DECLARED WAR ON SPAIN, JOINED BY CHILE. The cause of the war dated back to the Talambo Affair in 1862, when Spanish immigrants were attacked by Peruvian workers on the Talambo estate in northern **Peru**. Spain's demand for compensation was ignored, so it seized the **Chincha Islands** off the coast of Peru in 1864. These were valuable as a source of **guano**, used as fertilizer. Spain demanded 3 million pesos in exchange for the islands in 1865. Peru's General Mariano Ignacio Prado declared war on Spain in January 1866. Chile, fearful of a renewed Spanish presence in South America, joined Peru. They tried to close their ports, but Spain managed to bombard **Valparaíso** in Chile on March 31 and **Callao** in Peru on May 2 before a ceasefire the following week. This was the last attempt by Spain to recapture South American territory.



Battle of Callao
A detail of a painting shows Peruvian troops defending the fortified port of Callao, Peru, while being bombarded by the Spanish navy.



French painter Edouard Manet's *The execution of Maximilian I.*

“ A SPECTRE IS HAUNTING EUROPE; THE SPECTRE OF COMMUNISM. ”

Karl Marx, from the *Communist Manifesto*, 1848

FRANCE'S ATTEMPT TO GAIN CONTROL OF MEXICO (see 1863) seemed doomed with the arrival of US reinforcements. France abandoned Mexico's emperor, Maximilian I, who had been installed at their behest as well as that of Mexican monarchists. He was captured by liberal forces, court-martialed, and executed on June 19. Benito Juárez then returned to his post as president.

Farther north, the size of the US received a huge boost with the **purchase of the vast Alaska** territory from Russia. For the price of \$7.2 million, the US received 663,268 sq miles (1,717,856 sq km) of territory.

In Europe, Karl Marx (see panel, right) had published the first of three volumes in what would become one of his most influential works, *Das Kapital*. The book, through an examination of the capitalist system, tried to address larger economic and historical questions about the nature of class and social relations.

In **Prussia**, tensions with Austria had led to the **Seven Weeks' War** the previous year. Under the resulting Treaty of

April 9 Confederate General Robert E. Lee surrenders to General Ulysses S. Grant, effectively ending **American Civil War**

April 14 Assassination of Abraham Lincoln (b. 1809)

July 31 First narrow gauge mainline railroad in the world opens at Grandchester, Queensland, **Australia**

August 16 Dominican Republic regains independence from Spain

October 11 Paul Bogle leads the **Morant Bay Rebellion** in Jamaica

December 10 Léopold II becomes king of **Belgium**

Spain fails to retain Chincha Islands off coast of **Peru**

June 14–August 23 **Austro–Prussian war** starts over the Prussian occupation of the duchy of **Holstein**

October 14 French troops land at Ganghwa Island, **Korea**, in retaliation for execution of French Jesuit priests

January 11 Benito Juárez (1807–72) becomes president of **Mexico**

January 30 Emperor Kōmei dies; Crown Prince Mutsuhito becomes emperor of **Japan**

Karl Marx publishes first part of *Das Kapital*

Dual monarchy of **Austria–Hungary** established